vios
meaningful gastronomy

BRAND BOOK · ATELIER DEL GELATO

Atelier del Gelato — Brand Book v1.0 (draft edition, 2026-11-01)

Field	Value
Edition	**v1.0, draft** — the first edition of the fresh engagement opened 2026-11-01. It becomes v1.0 final on the founder's signature after the Move 1 sitting (open-facts 39).
Format	A, interrogation order (house standard 2026-11-01): the sections follow the fourteen interrogations, so each is the output of one skill and the book is also the engagement record. A Format B team edition is derived on request after this one is signed.
Assembled by	`vios-brand:vios-brand-book`, run by Vios (Menelaos Koulouris, partner and venue manager, with Claude)
Approver	Menelaos Koulouris (guardrails 10). Founder: Evo, who signs the book.
Live summary	`clients/atelier/brand-book.md` carries the identity table, Messages and story, the journey and the filter test for the operating skills; this file is the edition.
Register	neutral, practice voice; the manifesto in Part 1 is the one passage in the brand's voice

Sources inventoried (2026-11-01): `README.md` (intake record, 2026-11-01) · `diagnosis.md` (2026-11-01, **draft, unsigned**: the owner interview is not held, open-facts 7) · `brand-book.md` › Name and tagline, Messages and story, Filter test (2026-11-01) · `persona-bible.md` v1.0 (2026-11-01) · `fact-sheet.md` and `accounts.md` (carried from the archive, each row sourced and dated) · `open-facts.md` (rows 1–33 before this assembly) · `archive/naming.md`, `archive/deep-interrogation.md` (not held), `archive/filter-test-batches.md` · the founder's prior book, Brand Book v3 (7 Oct 2026, Drive, PDF id in `accounts.md`), read as his signed prior statement, with its §6 identity rules carried as facts through `clients/atelier-2026-10/brand-book.md` and the character-sheet README. **Missing:** a spoken owner interview; the POS pull (open-facts 15); review themes (16); the ten-competitor audit (17); a named designer (3); a visual reference set (37). The book is therefore issued as a draft edition with those sections marked **to confirm**, each a row in `open-facts.md`.

0. Foreword and how to use this book

Version history

Edition	Date	What it is
Brand Book v3 (founder's prior)	2026-10-07	Signed by Evo before this engagement. Not an edition of this book; the founder's prior statement of purpose, vision, mission, values, persona, positioning and interim identity rules. Re-interrogated in Stage 1 of this engagement; cited where its facts are used.
v1.0 draft	**2026-11-01**	First edition of the fresh run. Assembled from the 2026-11-01 diagnosis (draft), messages and story, persona Bible v1.0, the name and tagline check and the filter test.

What this edition takes from the founder's prior, and what it leaves

Taken as facts (sourced): the business, venues, hours, range and origin names; the name and the lock-up tagline; the Atelier Note and the ritual question; the persona's name Giulia; the §6 interim identity rules (Part 5.5, direction only); the content pillars and lengths (Part 7). Re-derived, not carried: the audience persona and archetype, the differentiator and positioning, the message architecture, the story, the persona's voice, the filter test. Where the fresh derivation landed where v3 did (the archetype Lover 70 / Innocent 30, the Role Peer, the persona Elena, the refusal of the transaction), the book says so and treats the agreement as evidence, not as inheritance.

What changed against v3, in substance: the editorial tagline "Italian joy crafted daily." is recommended dropped for "What are we celebrating today?" (Part 9, Evo decides); the AI-ambassador decision taken by the partner on 2026-10-30 is re-opened as a founder decision inside the value "Stay human" (Part 1, open-facts 26); "Baci" on the public surfaces is logged as a housekeeping fault rather than accepted (Part 9); the persona's voice is specified from the fresh diagnosis (Part 5.6) and the message architecture is written for the first time in the practice's form (Parts 7–8).

The Hero/Guide rule

The guest is the hero; the brand is the guide, beside her, as a Peer. Every part of this book obeys it: the story casts Elena as its hero, the messages state what she should understand, the persona looks up and asks and never performs itself, the identity direction refuses the product-only hero. Any section that makes the brand the hero of its own craft has failed the rule and is rewritten.

Who reads what

Reader	Parts
Evo (founder)	all; signs 1, 2, 6, 9, 12, 13
Menelaos (approver, venue manager)	all; owns 11, 13 and the live summary
The floor team	1 (manifesto and values), 4 (the ritual), 5.6 (voice, hard moments, checklist), 11; the Format B team edition when derived; the Stage 4 playbook
The identity designer	1–6, 9, Annex B; reads Part 5.5 as direction, not as identity
The practice (Stages 2–4, marketing loop)	all; the operating skills read `brand-book.md` and `persona-bible.md`
B2B partners	the story card and partner brief derived from Parts 4, 7, 8 (Stage 3), not this book

Direction until the designer delivers

Part 5.5 (Brand Identity Notes) and Annex B hold direction. Logo, colour system, type system and photographic style are produced by the designer from the brief; when delivered, they replace Part 5.5 and the edition number moves to v2.0.

1. Foundation — why we exist

Source: `diagnosis.md` §4 (steps 1–4), tested against the worksheet rules; the founder's words not yet heard (open-facts 7). The manifesto is the practice's draft in the brand's voice, written from the purpose and values, and is replaced by Evo's own words after the sitting if they differ.

Manifesto (brand voice, draft)

We think happiness is an attitude. Not a mood that arrives when the day is good, but a way of looking at an ordinary Tuesday. Most days have one small thing in them worth marking, and most of the time nobody marks it, including the person it happened to. So we ask. Every order, every counter, every day: what are we celebrating today? Nothing is a fine answer. You get the same scoop and the same card either way. The gelato was made this morning in our own Lab, the Italian way, with its true story and no shortcuts. The card is drawn by chance; it is yours. Ten minutes, nobody hurrying. That is the whole idea.

Purpose, vision, mission

Element	Statement (Brand Book v3, the founder's prior)	Worksheet finding (2026-11-01)
Purpose	To give everyone who believes everyday moments matter a pause to notice and celebrate one, crafted with care, every day.	**Passes.** Commitment (anyone who believes their moments matter), action (a pause), frequency (every guest, every day); already performed at Rakovski (the question and the Note exist). Not yet shown to run at the Ring Mall counter (contradiction 1, open-facts 9).
Vision	To be the name people think of when an everyday moment deserves celebrating, found in our own ateliers and at the tables of partners we choose.	Believable, 5–10 years, slightly under-scary: a position rather than a transformation. Evo is asked at the sitting whether his own version is bigger (open-facts 2). Carries the B2B line as first-class, which 53 % of Lab sales external justifies.
Mission	Every day, we craft fresh gelato and tiramisu the Italian way, with no shortcuts, and make sure each one reaches people with its story, so their moment is noticed and celebrated.	**Passes.** Present tense, checkable on the floor: fresh daily in small batches; Italian technique; every guest greeted personally; nothing leaves without its story; partners only if they serve that story.

Values, with operating statements and where each costs

Value	Operating statement	Where it costs	Lived or aspirational
Choose happiness (never fake it)	Cheer is never performed; a flat day is allowed and said lightly; no exclamation marks, no stock smile, the resting face between lines.	Hiring: a candidate who performs warmth is not hired, however skilled. Content: fewer "exciting" posts.	to confirm (open-facts 8)
Bring the attitude (hire for attitude, train skill)	The team is hired for how they meet people; scooping is trained afterwards.	Slower hiring; training time before a new hire serves alone (Stage 4).	to confirm (8)
Notice the moment (ask what you're celebrating)	Every order opens with the question; "nothing" is accepted and gets the same scoop and Note; the question is never dropped under queue pressure.	Seconds per order at the Ring Mall queue; the value's own hard case (contradiction 1, open-facts 9).	to confirm (8, 9)
Stay human (eye contact, names, no scripts, no kiosks)	A person with a name meets the guest; no self-service, no kiosk, no script.	No kiosk at the mall; the format of the online voice: whether a disclosed AI figure sits inside this value is **Evo's decision** (open-facts 26); until decided, no synthetic face or voice ships.	to confirm (8, 26)

Gate: purpose is neither empty nor performed. Stage 1 proceeds.

2. Audience — who we serve

Source: `diagnosis.md` §5 (step 5, four layers), built from Brand Book v3's persona and the Instagram baseline (2026-10-30), not yet from review mining or ten-plus competitor profiles (open-facts 16, 17). The founder's prior, to be checked rather than assumed.

Primary persona: Elena

Layer	Content
Demographics and psychographics	34, creative director, lives and works in central Sofia, personal income €2.5–3.2k/month, partnered, no children. Walks home along Rakovski with her day still on her shoulders. Specialty coffee, design and interiors, Instagram as a visual diary not a stage; COS-type clothes; quality over quantity; wants to be treated as a person.
Emotional insights	Pain: mass desserts feel empty; "healthy" feels joyless; cafés rush her; her small wins pass unmarked. Need: to feel her everyday moments matter. Before: busy, a little drained. After: calm, seen, lighter. Quotes (from the book, to be replaced by real ones from reviews and guest conversations): "I'd rather have one great thing than three average ones." · "If they remember my name, I'll come back."
Archetypal mix	**Creator 70 / Lover 30.** Drive: originality, self-expression, real quality. Fear: the mediocre, the duplicated, being processed as one of many. Situational desire at the counter: to be noticed as herself and to have something real in her hands in under a minute. Personality desire: "You see me, and you celebrate with me."
Brand Affinity Audit	COS · Aesop · Apple · Kinfolk · her specialty coffee bar. Patterns: restraint as a signal of quality; being addressed as a person; slowness as a luxury; a short curated range; a cultural reference worn lightly. Governs: a short menu, a quiet room, names used, no promo language, no cuteness, no theatre. **Speculative until ground-truthed with 3–5 real guests (open-facts 18).**

What the Instagram baseline adds: the two best pieces of Aug–Oct 2026 were real moments with people and places (an event cart, reach 1,491, 19 shares; a reel with 79 shares), not product shots (16–25 interactions). The audience already votes for the persona the book describes.

Second audience: B2B venue owners

Owners and managers of Sofia cafés and restaurants buying from the Lab; 53 % of Lab sales Jun 2025–Aug 2026. Need: a product they can serve under their own roof without embarrassment, reliable fresh delivery, and a reason to choose this Lab over a cheaper tub, which the brand answers with the story card on their tables. Names, count and tenure of current partners: **to confirm (open-facts 19)**; the one-paragraph venue-owner persona is written when that closes. A venue owner who walks into Rakovski is Elena for those ten minutes: one welcome on the floor.

Competitors (step 6)

Five from the October 2026 audit (per-competitor scores in Drive; the method wants ten, re-run before this edition is final, open-facts 17).

Competitor	What they own
Doppio	"joy every day", the one emotional word in the category; cream-and-green identity
Gelateria Naturale	provenance as proof: own farm, origin on the label
Afreddo, Gelato & Latte	volume gelato chains; named staff create loyalty where it exists; guests police authenticity in reviews
Franco's Nuvole	tiramisu as a specialist category; novelty formats

Ideas worth adopting: provenance stated as fact; named staff; tiramisu as a serious category; packaging with personality. **Opportunities (the gaps):** service and warmth is the category's weakest point in reviews; no competitor owns a ritual; nobody combines premium gelato with a serious tiramisu collection; nobody makes honesty (no hype, true origins, no added sugar said plainly) a visible promise; nobody supplies venues with a story attached. The purpose already stands in all five gaps, which is the sign the positioning is credible rather than wished.

Differentiator (step 7) and positioning (step 9)

Experience keywords: noticed · celebrated · unhurried · fresh today · true story · together.

The one thing: every order opens with "What are we celebrating today?" and closes with an Atelier Note drawn by chance. It turns a 60-second transaction into a moment the guest carries out of the door, costs no theatre, only people, and so travels to a mall counter and a partner's table. **Onliness:** the only gelato and tiramisu atelier where every order becomes a small celebration of your day.

The brand belief, held separately from the differentiator: "Happiness is an attitude." The belief is why; the question and the Note are what. The belief is never the front of the differentiator and never a reply to a person (Part 8, "the belief deployed").

The differentiator performed: the question at the counter, a beat of silence, "nothing" accepted, two flavours tasted together, the card drawn by chance from the jar and handed with eye contact, a card in every B2B delivery. Who draws the card and when it is handed, as practised today: open-facts 28.

Positioning statement: We help people in Sofia who believe their everyday moments matter but feel processed and rushed wherever they go, to experience a short pause in which their moment is noticed and celebrated, unlike gelato shops that sell product and tiramisu bars that sell novelty; our solution is fresh Italian gelato and tiramisu handed over with a question and a note.

Full statement and the proposals it rejects: Part 6.

3. Soul — who we are

Source: `diagnosis.md` §8 (step 8, instruments 1–4), `persona-bible.md` v1.0 §1–2, 4. Carried as the diagnosis found it; the founder re-reads it at the sitting.

The audience link and the Brand Role

Elena's personality desire is company for a minute: "You see me, and you celebrate with me." Not advice, not inspiration, not protection. The Role that answers it is **Peer**. Connection statement: "Your day matters to us as much as it does to you, so let's celebrate it together." The ritual only works side by side ("what are *we* celebrating"); Guide or Inspiration would put the brand above the counter; Caregiver would make the guest a patient.

Brand archetypal mix

	Archetype	Characteristics the brand takes	Characteristics it refuses
Core (70)	**Lover**	closeness, affection, red-carpet treatment for an ordinary day; its fear of invisibility mirrors Elena's fear of being processed	sensuality, heaviness, devotion as display (the Dec 2025 "poetic, sensual, devotional" register is not this brand)
Influencer (30)	**Innocent**	lightness, honesty, simplicity, optimism without deceit	cuteness, naivety, party energy. **Guardrail: Innocent stays light, never cute.**

Rejected pairs, with reasons: Caregiver (guest as patient; the brand is beside her, not above); Jester (party energy breaks the pause); Creator as primary (makes the brand the hero of its own craft; the guest is the hero). Drive: that one ordinary day gets noticed. Desire: to be the place people think of when something small deserves marking. Fear: being the transaction, the fake, the faceless.

The eight expression dimensions as one imagined person

A warm peer in her early thirties. Physical presence: in the room, at the counter, never the hero of the frame. Dress and style: linen in cream, sage and caramel; nothing styled-perfect. Accessories: a pencil behind the ear, a worn notebook of guests' names; no devices between her and the guest. Language and vocabulary: plain; "we" and "today"; one question before a statement. Tone of voice: warm, 4 of 5, never gushing. Volume: low, 2 of 5; no exclamation energy. Attitude: lightly playful, 2 of 5, earnest without solemnity. Beliefs: spoken rarely; "Happiness is an attitude" said once in a while, never as a reply. She never says "Next!" or "our bestseller". Slider positions and the one-notch-either-way readings: `persona-bible.md` §5.

The brand's point of view toward the world

On the city: Rakovski is the street people walk home along with the day on their shoulders; the Atelier is the ten minutes that set it down. On Ring Mall: the same question in a queue, which is harder and not optional (open-facts 9). On gelato: made this morning, true origins, nothing hyped, eight flavours are enough. On tiramisu: a collection made quietly behind the scenes, never theatre; what carries the winter. On the Mindful line: no added sugar, said plainly, no lecture. On

partners: only venues that will ask the question at their own tables; chosen, not sold to. **On money, growth and mistakes: to confirm** (open-facts 35); the book will not invent a founder's view of his own balance sheet.

Persona in Practice (instrument 6): where it lives

The nine layers are carried in `persona-bible.md` v1.0, which is Part 5.6 of this book by reference; Annex A compresses them into the AI Persona Brief. Format (real team + written voice, or a disclosed AI host) is the founder's decision (open-facts 26).

4. Differentiator — the ritual as an operating decision

Source: `diagnosis.md` §7, `fact-sheet.md` (signature asset and ritual rows, 2026-10-30), `brand-book.md` › Journey (provisional).

The differentiator is not a line; it is an order of operations at two counters and in every delivery box.

Moment	What happens	Status
Arrival	eyes up before words; a greeting by name if known	designed in Stage 3
Ordering (**signature, provisional**)	"What are we celebrating today?"; a beat of silence; "nothing" accepted with "then just something good"; two flavours tasted together; no bestseller, no add-on	the question and its acceptance of "nothing" are facts (fact sheet, Bible hard moments); the two-flavour taste is the practice's reading, to observe
Making (**peak, provisional**)	scooped without theatre; the Atelier Note drawn by chance from the jar and handed for her moment	the Note exists (25 cards, print file in Drive, in the jar); who draws it and when: open-facts 28
The pause	a chair, silence, the card read; ten minutes that are a pause, not a wait	Stage 2 observation
Departure (**end, provisional**)	goodbye by name, attention held to the door	Stage 2 observation
Delivery (B2B)	fresh from the Lab in the morning, story cards on top	fact sheet; partner names open-facts 19

The Ring Mall counter is where the differentiator is tested: ~34 % of kilos and nothing on file says the question is asked there. If it is not, the mall is a second brand expression with its own map; if it is shortened, the queue learns the question is optional. Founder's answer before Stage 2 (open-facts 9).

5. Personality — how we show and sound

5.1 Audience link, 5.2 Role and Connection, 5.3 Archetypal mix, 5.4 Expression

Parts 3's sections, one to one; not repeated here.

5.5 Brand Identity Notes (instrument 5) — direction until the designer delivers

Source: Brand Book v3 §6 (7 Oct 2026, the founder's signed interim rules and his own direction for the refresh), carried as facts through `clients/atelier-2026-10/brand-book.md` and `character-sheet/README.md`; `diagnosis.md` §6 (Doppio's cream-and-green); `persona-bible.md` §9–10 (expression palette, negative list). Values are to be verified against the v3 PDF before they go to a designer (open-facts 34). The reasoning column is the practice's, from the personality.

Field	Interim rules in force (v3 §6)	Direction for the refresh	Reasoning from the personality
Colour palette	Base Vanilla #F8F3E2 · Text Chocolate #3B2A20 · Lead Pistachio #BDD0B6 · Secondary Caramel #D4AA7D, Rose #E8C4C8, Gold #D4B572	Lead moves to a warm apricot (≈ #E5A07A per v3's own note); Pistachio, Rose and Gold become secondary only; cream-and-green is Doppio's territory	Lover warmth without heaviness: a warm, light lead; Innocent kept light by cream, never by pastel pink; restraint (Elena's affinity set) means few colours, used quietly
Typography	Headings Playfair Display · Body Montserrat Light · Notes Caveat	A warm humanist serif for headings · a humanist sans for body · a handwriting face drawn from real team handwriting for the Notes and story cards	Humanist, not geometric: the register of a person, not a system; the hand-written face is the Note's own voice and must be real handwriting (guardrails 2, 5 in spirit: nothing faked)
Image style	Real guests mid-moment (with permission), hands giving Notes, gelato and tiramisu made today, warm natural light, soft contrast	Refuse: posed perfection, product-only heroes, stock smiles, pastel kitsch, process theatre, "Baci", any retired "alla minute" marks	The guest is the hero of the frame; the expression palette in `persona-bible.md` §9 sets the faces (warmth 3, pride 2, sincerity 2; party energy capped)
Logo (interim rules)	Warm brown wordmark; black formal, white on dark; clear space = height of "A"; min 25 mm / 150 px; never stretch, recolour, shadow	Refresh by the designer; the lock-up carries the lock-up tagline and both descriptors; the editorial line never enters the lock-up	Part 9's two-line tagline system

Field	Interim rules in force (v3 §6)	Direction for the refresh	Reasoning from the personality
Graphic elements	Botanical line drawings, abstract swirls, paper and linen textures, sparingly; tiramisu-layer lines and alla minute marks retired	The Atelier Note and the story card are the signature assets; everything else is secondary	The differentiator made visible (Part 4)
Visual reference set	**not on file**	to collect: images that bring the peer in linen to life, from the atelier's own plates where possible (`atelier-2026-10/character-sheet/README.md` lists three usable plates)	open-facts 37

Colours are specified in Pantone, CMYK and RGB only once the designer delivers; the hex values above are the v3 interim rules, not a palette specification.

5.6 Persona in Practice — Giulia (by reference to `persona-bible.md` v1.0)

Layer	Where	One line
1 Persona core	Bible §1–2	"We are the warm peer behind the counter who looks up first, asks before she tells, and makes sure one good thing in your day gets noticed." Carrier model: distributed (the real team on the floor and on camera, Giulia as the written voice) in Format A; unified around a disclosed AI host in Format B. Decided by Evo (open-facts 26).
2 Traits	Bible §4	warm (never gushing) · attentive to this person (never generic) · unhurried (never slow or precious) · light (never cute) · honest (never hyped) · a peer (never a teacher or carer) · quietly proud (never theatre). Never-trait: pushy.
3 Tone sliders	Bible §5	eight dimensions scored, one notch either way described
4 Moment and touchpoint map	Bible §8	channel × moment matrix; journey placement with speaks / present / silent
5 Do and don't	Bible §5	five pairs EN/BG; the tempting mistake named each time
6 Word rules	Bible §5	"it is" adjectives, "it has" nouns, verbs, house terms (the Atelier / „Ателието", the Lab, the case, the card or the Note, guests not customers), never-words (bestseller, indulgent, artisanal, premium, authentic, experience, organic, natural, sugar-free, gluten-free until open-facts 13, special offer, hurry, last chance, "Baci"); mechanics (sentences under 15 words, one question per piece, no exclamation marks, ти on social, Вие in letters and B2B)

Layer	Where	One line
7 Hard moments	Bible §5	the Ring Mall queue · "nothing, I just want ice cream" · the price question · "is it gluten-free" · a bad public review · 19:58 · saying no to a venue
8 Final checklist	Bible §5	ten lines; line 1 is the filter test
9 Operational link	opened here, completed in Stages 2–4	each trait must show in at least one floor behaviour: warm → eyes up before words; attentive → the question, names; unhurried → the chair and the silence; light → "nothing" accepted lightly; honest → one true fact, the price once; peer → "what are *we* celebrating"; quietly proud → scooped without theatre

Address register: BG ти / EN "you" on social and at the counter; Вие / plain formal in letters and B2B; a guest is answered in the register and language she writes in. **Emoji:** none in captions, Notes, cards, Google posts, emails; at most one non-face emoji in a reply, mirroring the guest. **No exclamation marks anywhere** (the founder's own rule, v3 §3.1).

Filter test (`vios-filter-test` , 2026-11-01): **Is this talking to the order?** — does it hurry her, sell to her, or speak to no one in particular? Pass = no. BG: „Говорим ли на поръчката?" (to be said aloud by the team, open-facts 33). Markers, passes, fails and scope: `brand-book.md` › Filter test; regression batches in `archive/filter-test-batches.md` . The test is the first line of the ten-line checklist and the "Filter test" check in `vios-consistency-qa` .

6. Positioning statement — and the positioning as a working tool

Source: `diagnosis.md` §7 (step 9). The rejected proposals are drawn from the current feed and the archive's record (Instagram baseline 2026-10-30; retired v3 items), so each is a real temptation the brand has already met, not an invented one.

We help people in Sofia who believe their everyday moments matter but feel processed and rushed wherever they go, **to** experience a short pause in which their moment is noticed and celebrated, **unlike** gelato shops that sell product and tiramisu bars that sell novelty; **our solution is** fresh Italian gelato and tiramisu handed over with a question and a note.

The statement is internal; it is never copy. It is used as a working tool: a proposal that does not fit inside it is declined, whatever its reach.

Proposal the brand has met	Verdict	Why, in the statement's words
"Students 15 % off, show your card" and "special promotional price" posts (current feed)	rejected	sells to a segment, not to a person; no reference price (guardrails 3); the pause is not a discount
"Tiramisù à la minute" in-front theatre (retired by v3, posters still on the 1 Jul shop-front photo)	rejected	makes the craft the hero and the guest the audience; the solution is the question and the note, not a show
"Sofia's finest artisan gelato" superlative captions, exclamation marks, emoji strings (current feed)	rejected	speaks to no one in particular; the brand's only claim is that it notices her
A self-service or kiosk counter for the Ring Mall queue	rejected	the value "Stay human" and the differentiator both die at a kiosk; if the question cannot survive the queue, the answer is staffing and choreography (Stage 3), not automation
"Italian joy crafted daily" as a second belief beside "Happiness is an attitude"	recommended rejected	two beliefs in two registers; "joy" is Doppio's word; Evo decides (open-facts 30)

7. Core message blocks

Source: `brand-book.md` › Messages and story, written 2026-11-01 by `vios-messages-and-story` from the draft diagnosis; reproduced here word for word so the live summary and the edition cannot drift (the live summary records this edition, v1.0 draft, in its heading). Every block states what the guest should understand; none is copy. Where the diagnosis is the founder's prior, the block inherits that status and is re-read after the sitting.

Core messages

#	Short name	Tier	What the guest should understand
1	Your moment	primary (audience)	This is for people who believe their ordinary days hold things worth marking, and who are tired of places that do not look up.
2	Not an order	primary (pain)	Everywhere else, dessert is a transaction: fast, friendly in the generic way, and forgotten; her small win walks out unmarked, and "healthy" is the joyless aisle.
3	The pause	primary (benefit)	Here, ten minutes become a pause in which someone notices her and what today was, and she leaves lighter, with something in her hands that was made this morning.
4	Ask, not sell	primary (alternative)	Gelato shops sell product, tiramisu bars sell novelty; both serve her as one of many. Here nobody is sold to; she is asked.
5	The question and the Note	primary (differentiator)	Every order opens with "What are we celebrating today?" and closes with a Note drawn by chance, so the moment leaves with her.
6	Happiness is an attitude	secondary (purpose)	Happiness is not a mood that arrives; it is a way of looking at an ordinary Tuesday, and this place practises it on her behalf, every day.
7	The name people think of	secondary (vision)	When something in her day deserves marking, this is where she thinks of first, in the ateliers or at a partner's table.
8	Fresh, the Italian way, with its story	secondary (mission)	What she is handed was made today, by Italian technique without shortcuts, and it comes with its true story, never without.
9	Choose happiness	secondary (value)	Nobody here performs cheer; if the day is flat, the team says so lightly and chooses happiness anyway, which is different from faking it.
10	Bring the attitude	secondary (value)	The people behind the counter were hired for how they meet people; the skill was trained afterwards.
11	Notice the moment	secondary (value)	Someone will ask what she is celebrating, and "nothing" is an acceptable answer that gets the same scoop and the same Note.

#	Short name	Tier	What the guest should understand
12	Stay human	secondary (value)	A person with a name meets her, with eye contact and no script; nothing between her and the counter is automated. **To confirm:** whether a disclosed AI figure on screen sits inside this value or outside it is Evo's decision (open-facts 26).

Integrity rule: a piece reinforces at least one, contradicts none. Enforced by the `vios-consistency-qa` check "Message anchor".

Primary messages in house format

1 — Your moment. For: Elena, 34, central Sofia, walking home along Rakovski with the day still on her shoulders; and the venue owner who walks in and is Elena for ten minutes. Pain: her small wins pass unmarked. Understanding we want to create: ordinary days hold things worth marking, and this place thinks so too. Emotional value: recognition. Competitors say "treat yourself"; we say "what are we celebrating today?". Where it lives: discovery posts (a real guest's moment, with permission), the story card, the question at the counter.

2 — Not an order. For: the same Elena, in the queue at any counter in the city. Pain: processed as one of many; "Next!"; the generic friendly; the joyless healthy option. Understanding we want to create: she is a person before she is an order, here and nowhere else in the category. Emotional value: relief. Competitors say "fast, friendly service"; we say nothing — we look up. Where it lives: the arrival (eyes up before words), the no-script rule, the Mindful line stated plainly without a lecture.

3 — The pause. For: Elena at the end of a working day; a group on a Saturday. Pain: rushed everywhere. Understanding we want to create: ten minutes here are a pause, not a wait; nobody hurries her through choosing, tasting or reading her Note. Emotional value: calm; feeling lighter on the way out. Competitors say "grab a scoop"; we say "take your time". Where it lives: the tasting of two flavours together, the silence while she reads the card, the chair by the window, the closing line said to her by name.

4 — Ask, not sell. For: Elena and the venue owner. Pain: being upsold, anchored, told what everyone takes. Understanding we want to create: here she is asked a question and the answer is accepted, including "nothing"; nothing is pushed, no bestseller, no add-on. Emotional value: trust. Competitors say "our bestseller is…"; we say "same as last time, or shall we look?". Where it lives: the ordering moment, the two-flavour taste, every caption's single question, the B2B conversation (a partner is chosen, not sold to).

5 — The question and the Note. For: every guest at every counter, including Ring Mall (how it survives a queue: open-facts 9). Pain: the moment leaves no trace. Understanding we want to create: the question opens the moment and the Note closes it; she can carry it out of the door. Emotional value: being seen, and a small thing to keep. Competitors say "enjoy!"; we say "there's a card in the bag; it's yours". Where it lives: the ritual itself (signature = the question, provisional peak = the Note), the jar on the counter, the card in every B2B delivery, the after-visit reply when a guest posts her card.

Secondary messages

Message	Underlying belief	Understanding we want to create	Reinforces (behaviours, choices, refusals)
6 Happiness is an attitude	everyday moments deserve to be noticed and celebrated (purpose)	happiness is practised, not awaited, and this place practises it for her	the question asked every time; no "treat yourself"; the lock-up tagline

Message	Underlying belief	Understanding we want to create	Reinforces (behaviours, choices, refusals)
7 The name people think of	vision: the first name when a moment deserves marking, in own ateliers and at chosen partners' tables	there is one place in Sofia for this	partners chosen for whether they will serve the story; a mall counter that runs the same ritual
8 Fresh, the Italian way, with its story	mission: fresh daily, small batches, Italian technique, nothing leaves without its story	what she holds was made today and has a true origin	"made this morning" only when true; origins named only from the fact sheet; the Note and the story card; no "organic", "best", "natural"
9 Choose happiness	value: never fake it	a flat day is allowed; cheer is never performed	no exclamation marks; no stock smile; the resting face between lines
10 Bring the attitude	value: hire for attitude, train skill	the person behind the counter is there for how she meets people	hiring and training order (Stage 4); named staff on the floor and, with consent, online
11 Notice the moment	value: ask what you're celebrating	she will be asked, and "nothing" is fine	the question; the no-push rule after a "no"; the same scoop and Note either way
12 Stay human	value: eye contact, names, no scripts, no kiosks	a person meets her, not a process	no kiosks; names used once known; the AI-figure question decided by the founder, not footnoted (open-facts 26)

Tone by moment (one voice, calibrated; hours 11:00–20:00, two counters)

Moment	Direction	Example (register, not copy)
Late morning (11–13)	quietest hour; the regulars and the coffee; tone low, familiar	"The usual, or shall we look at today's two?"
Afternoon (13–17)	families, the mall footfall; tone light, patient, never rushed by the queue	"Thanks for waiting. What are we celebrating today?"
Golden hour (17–19)	Elena walking home; the tone the brand is built for: warm, unhurried, one question	"Long day? Then just something good."
Closing hour (19–20)	tiramisu and boxes; tone warm, attention held to the door	"Who's it for? We'll choose the twelve together."
Online, any hour	one person's moment, one question back, no hype	"Today was Maria's exam. What's yours?"

8. Story framework, the belief deployed, the journey and the micro-message blocks

Source: as Part 7. The journey is provisional until the Stage 2 map (`vios-journey:vios-journey-map`) sets the peak, the signature and the end after the observation move.

Story framework (guest = hero, brand = guide)

Block	One line
1 Existing world	Elena, 34, walks Rakovski home most evenings with her day still on her shoulders; her life is good and nobody marks its small wins.
2 Obstacle	Every place on the way treats her as the next order: fast, generically friendly, forgotten; dessert is a transaction and "healthy" is joyless.
3 Call to action	A Tuesday with something small in it (a sign-off, a passed test, a hard day survived) and no one to tell; if she walks past again, the moment is gone by the time she gets home.
4 Meeting the guide	She steps into the Atelier; someone looks up before speaking and asks what we are celebrating today; the case holds eight flavours made this morning, nothing shouts.
5 The challenge	Saying it out loud feels small, almost silly; the real risk is being met with the generic friendly again.
6 Transformation	The answer is received as it is, two flavours are tasted together, a card is drawn by chance and handed to her for her moment; ten minutes, no hurry, and she walks out lighter with the card in her pocket.
7 New world	Her days have a place where they get noticed; she tells a friend, "they asked what I was celebrating, and I actually told them."

Long form, EN then BG (rewritten, not translated):

1. **The existing world.** Elena is thirty-four and runs a small design team in the centre of Sofia. She walks home along Rakovski most evenings with the day still on her shoulders. Her life is good. It is also unmarked: the sign-off that went through, the client who finally said yes, the Tuesday she got through, none of it gets noticed by anyone, including her.
2. **The obstacle.** On the way home every counter treats her as the next order. The service is fast and friendly in the way that is friendly to no one. Dessert is a transaction. The "healthy" option is the joyless one. She has stopped expecting to be seen; she expects to be served.
3. **The call to action.** One evening there is something small in the day worth marking and nobody to tell. If she walks past again, the moment is gone by the time she gets home, and it will not come back.
4. **Meeting the guide.** She steps into the Atelier on Rakovski. Somebody looks up before saying anything. Eight flavours made this morning, a jar of cards on the counter, nothing shouting. The person asks, as if it were the most

ordinary question, what we are celebrating today.

5. **The challenge.** Saying it out loud feels small, almost silly. The real risk is not the price or the choice; it is being met with the generic friendly again, and feeling foolish for having answered.
6. **The transformation.** The answer is taken as it is. Two flavours are tasted together; a card is drawn by chance and handed over for her moment. Ten minutes, nobody hurrying. She walks out lighter, with the card in her pocket.
7. **The new world.** Her days have a place where they get noticed. She tells a friend: "They asked what I was celebrating. And I actually told them."

BG:

1. **Съществуващият свят.** Елена е на трийсет и четири и води малък дизайнерски екип в центъра на София. Повечето вечери се прибира по „Раковски" с деня още на раменете си. Животът ѝ е добър. И незабелязан: одобреният проект, клиентът, който най-после каза „да", вторникът, който издържа — никой не ги отбелязва, включително тя.
2. **Пречката.** По пътя към къщи всеки щанд я посреща като следващата поръчка. Обслужването е бързо и любезно по начина, който е любезен към никого. Десертът е транзакция. „Здравословното" е тъжното. Отдавна не очаква някой да я види; очаква да я обслужат.
3. **Зовът.** Една вечер в деня има нещо малко, което си заслужава, и няма на кого да го каже. Ако подмине пак, до вкъщи моментът ще е отминал и няма да се върне.
4. **Срещата с водача.** Влиза в Ателието на „Раковски". Някой вдига поглед, преди да каже каквото и да е. Осем вкуса, направени тази сутрин, буркан с картички на щанда, нищо не крещи. Човекът пита, сякаш е най-обикновеният въпрос, какво празнуваме днес.
5. **Изпитанието.** Да го каже на глас ѝ се струва дребно, почти глупаво. Истинският риск не е цената или изборът; а пак да срещне общата любезност и да се почувства смешна, че е отговорила.
6. **Промяната.** Отговорът е приет такъв, какъвто е. Опитва два вкуса заедно; картичка, изтеглена на късмет, ѝ е подадена за нейния момент. Десет минути, никой не бърза. Излиза по-лека, с картичката в джоба.
7. **Новият свят.** Дните ѝ имат място, където ги забелязват. Казва на приятелка: „Попитаха ме какво празнувам. И аз наистина им казах."

The belief, deployed. "Happiness is an attitude." / „Щастието е нагласа." Used when the moment calls for narrative rather than category: the lock-up, the monthly letter, the story card's back, the welcome to new staff. Never at the front of the differentiator and never as a reply to a person.

Second audience, thin until open-facts 19 closes. The venue owner's arc is the same frame at the partner table: existing world (a café that serves a tub nobody asks about), obstacle (a cheaper supplier is always available), call (a guest asks where the tiramisu is from), guide (a Lab that delivers fresh in the morning with story cards), challenge (will the staff ask the question), transformation (a table where someone far from Rakovski was asked about their day), new world ("our gelato has a story and it isn't ours, and that's fine"). **To confirm** against real partners before it is used.

Journey (guest order; owner = marketing or floor)

Stage 2 map drafted 2026-11-01 (`journey/journey-map.md` , **draft on the unsigned v1.0 edition, observation move not held**; 33 moments, 6 HIGH). Canonical touchpoints from `vios-guardrails` , adapted for walk-in retail: **booking and reminder dropped**; "the evening" renamed **the pause** (the purpose's own word); the B2B line adds **partner table** and **delivery**. The marker column points at the moment codes; the peak ◉ M18, the signature ★ M09 and the end ⊐ M25+M26 are the draft map's and stay **provisional** until the Reasoning Note is signed (open-facts 49) and the observation move is held (40).

#	Touchpoint	Guest state and tension	Designed moment to show	Owner	Marker
1	Discovery	"Is this a place for a day like mine?" — scrolling, tired, suspicious of cute	a real guest's moment, with permission, and the question asked back to the reader	marketing	M01
2	Profile check	"Where, when, and is it real?" — the handle and the listing still say "Baci" (open-facts 23, 24)	hours, address, descriptor, the two counters; the disclosure line if an AI figure exists (26)	marketing	M02
3	Arrival	"Will anyone look up?"	eyes up before words, at both counters; at the mall, "thanks for waiting" as a fact	floor	M03–M08 (M06 HIGH; M08 ○)
4	Ordering	"Do I have to perform, or can I just say it?"	"What are we celebrating today?"; "nothing" accepted; two flavours tasted together; no push	floor	★ signature M09 · M09–M16 (M11 HIGH; M10 ○)
5	Making	"Is this for me or for the queue?"	scooped without theatre; the Note drawn by chance from the jar and handed for her moment	floor	◉ peak M18 · M17–M20
6	The pause	"Nobody's hurrying me."	the chair, the card read, silence held; ten minutes that are a pause, not a wait	floor	M21–M24 (M22, M23 ○)
7	Departure	"Will they still be with me at the door?"	the goodbye by name, attention held until she is out	floor	⊐ end M25 + M26
8	After-visit	"That card is on my desk."	a one-line reply by name when she posts it; letters in Вие; the name remembered on return (email capture: open-facts 29)	marketing · floor	M27, M29, M30
9	Review	"I said it; did they hear it?"	every guest asked, never rewarded; reply drafted for Menelaos, signed by him	marketing	M28
10	Partner table	"Someone far from Rakovski asked about my day." (guest) · "This is a partner, not a supplier." (owner)	the story card on a partner's table asking the same question; partners chosen, not sold to	marketing · partner	M31, M33 (thin until open-facts 19)
11	Delivery	"It arrived with its story."	fresh from the Lab in the morning, story cards on top	floor (Lab)	M32

Micro-message blocks (per touchpoint)

Block	Touchpoint	Anchors	Customer state · tension	Understanding to create	Non-verbal · verbal expression	Success signal	Failure modes
1	Arrival	2 Not an order · 12 Stay human · story 4	tired, braced for "Next!" · will anyone look up	a person has seen me before I ordered	eyes up within seconds, smile before words; a greeting by name if known, else a plain hello; at the mall queue, "thanks for waiting"	she relaxes her shoulders; a regular is greeted by name	greeting from the till not the eyes; a scripted welcome; apologising for the queue
2	Ordering	5 The question and the Note · 4 Ask, not sell · 11 Notice the moment · story 4–5	choosing, slightly exposed · do I have to perform	I will be asked, and any answer is right, including none	a beat of silence after the question; "What are we celebrating today?"; "nothing" met with "then just something good"; two flavours offered to taste together; no bestseller, no add-on	she answers; or says nothing and is not pushed; a taste accepted	the question skipped under pressure; a flavour pushed; "anything else?"; the question said as a slogan

Block	Touchpoint	Anchors	Customer state · tension	Understanding to create	Non-verbal · verbal expression	Success signal	Failure modes
3	Making	5 The question and the Note · 8 Fresh, the Italian way · story 6	watching, hopeful · is this for me	what I hold was made today and this card is mine	scooped without theatre; the card drawn by chance, handed with eye contact: "a card for your moment"	she reads the card before she leaves; she keeps it	the card chosen for her; the card dropped in the bag unmentioned; process theatre at the counter
4	The pause	3 The pause · 6 Happiness is an attitude · story 6	reading, tasting · is it alright to stay	ten minutes here are a pause, not a wait	silence; a chair offered; no clearing of the table while she is there; nothing said unless she opens	she stays the ten minutes; she photographs the card	staff hovering; music or tone that hurries; "all good?" interruptions
5	Departure	7 The name people think of · 3 The pause · story 7	leaving lighter · will they still be with me	they were with me to the door	the goodbye by name, attention held until she is out; "until the next one"	she looks back; she returns within the month	the goodbye said to the next person; "have a nice day" to the till

Block	Touchpoint	Anchors	Customer state · tension	Understanding to create	Non-verbal · verbal expression	Success signal	Failure modes
6	Online: discovery, profile check	1 Your moment · 5 The question and the Note · 9 Choose happiness · story 1–4	scrolling, suspicious of cute · is this real	this place notices real people's real days, and it is where it says it is	real guests mid-moment with permission; one question back; no exclamation marks, no emoji strings; facts on the profile; the disclosure line if 26 resolves to AI	saves and shares over likes; DMs that answer the question	product-only heroes; staged moments; "#glutenfree" without the Lab's line (open-facts 13); promo prices (12)
7	Online: after-visit, review	7 The name people think of · 11 Notice the moment · story 7	the card on the desk · did they hear me	they remembered, and they ask everyone the same way	reply by name, one line; review ask of every guest, no reward; letters in Вие	a reply to the reply; reviews that mention the question or the card (count, raw numbers)	form-letter replies; a review request that gates on satisfaction; a reply drafted on an escalation topic (guardrails 11)
8	Partner table and delivery (B2B)	7 The name people think of · 8 Fresh, the Italian way · 4 Ask, not sell	the owner: supplier or partner · the guest: a question far from Rakovski	the Lab's story travels with the product; partners are chosen	Вие; facts of freshness and origin; the story card on the table; no price pressure	a partner's staff ask the question; first enquiries from content (raw count)	selling to a venue that will not serve the story; story cards left in the box; "to confirm" until open-facts 19

Closing test (2026-11-01)

- Differentiator solves the pain for this audience: **yes** — "processed as one of many" is answered by a question addressed to her and a card that is hers.
- Positioning uses the differentiator as its solution and the five primary blocks say the same as the formula: **yes** — "a question and a note" in both.
- Each secondary traces to purpose, vision, mission or a value without a new belief: **yes**; message 12 carries the founder's open decision rather than a new belief.
- The story casts the audience as a hero the brand can credibly guide as a Peer: **yes** — the guide looks up and asks; it does not lead or lecture.
- Any block reads as copy: **no** after rewrite (block 3's "take your time" and block 5's "there's a card in the bag" are kept as register examples, labelled so).
- Any micro-message block contradicts a core message: **no**; block 6's AI-disclosure line is conditional on open-facts 26, which is where the only contradiction (value 12) lives and is owned by the founder.

Nothing goes back to the diagnosis from this test; what goes back is the interview that the diagnosis itself is waiting on (open-facts 7).

9. Brand name and tagline

Source: `archive/naming.md` and `archive/deep-interrogation.md` (2026-11-01, `vios-name-and-tagline` run as a check of an existing name; the interrogation itself not yet held, open-facts 7).

The interrogation. The eleven deep questions are set out EN/BG with the verbatim column empty. The diagnostic finding: the thin step is the owner interview itself, not any earlier step; the keyword set (24 keywords, sourced) was drawn from the diagnosis and is re-run against Evo's answers. Three things the answers are mined for: whether "celebrate" is his word or the book's; whether "Italian" is craft or mood to him (decides the editorial line); whether gelato and tiramisu carry equal weight (the name carries one).

The name: Atelier del Gelato, kept. Entered in the long list as the literal it is and tested against four fresh candidates (Ателието as spoken form, Oggi, Small Wins, Gelato & Nota). Passes every strategy test (Lover/Innocent and Peer fit, positioning fit in part, expression fit, Elena's affinity register), is distinct on its first word, and carries ~1,130 reviews of equity. Findings that are not a rename: the spoken short form **"the Atelier" / „Ателието"** is the real working name and is written into the house terms; tiramisu and the winter are carried by the descriptor system (ateliers "Gelato · Tiramisu · Caffè", B2B "Gelato & Tiramisu"), not by the name; Oggi is on file as the one fresh candidate that would pass, for a future second format. Housekeeping: "Baci" is still on the Instagram handle and the Google listing (open-facts 23, 24); ownership (domains, trademark classes 30 and 43, handles without "Baci") has never been checked (31).

The two-line tagline system.

Line	Text	Use	Status
Lock-up	**Happiness is an attitude.** / „Щастието е нагласа."	with the wordmark and the descriptors; the monthly letter, the story card's back, the welcome to new staff	keep (belief, not claim; one thing next to the name)
Editorial	**What are we celebrating today?** / „Какво празнуваме днес?"	story-facing: feed, story cards, email headers, the B2B story card; also the line the counter says	**recommended**, replacing "Italian joy crafted daily." (joy is Doppio's; the retired #italianjoy line; two beliefs next to the name). Evo decides (open-facts 30)

The editorial line is the one brand asset that is also a line said to a guest; it is judged by the naming tests as an asset and by the filter test in that use, and passes both. The lock-up is never said to a person.

10. Designer selection

Source: § 2.1.2.14 of the method; `README.md` Move 1 Q3 and open-facts 3. A visual identity refresh is in scope ("identity refresh pending a designer", Brand Book v3 §6).

No candidate is on file: Brand Book v3 refers to a designer without naming one (open-facts 3). The six criteria are set out so the selection can run in one sitting once candidates exist (open-facts 36).

Criterion	Sufficient answer	Candidate 1	Candidate 2
Processes	asks for the strategy before designing; evidenced by their intake questions	—	—
Language	BG or EN as a native, or summarises this book back in their own words	—	—
Variation	portfolio across industries and registers, not one style	—	—
Style guide	commits to delivering one	—	—
Interview	a video call; the founder can speak openly with them, including when the work is difficult	—	—
The brief	receives this book with Part 5.5 and Annex B and commits to designing within it; takes the lead in asking for what is missing	—	—

Recommendation: none until candidates are scored. The owner chooses. The brief (Annex B) is ready to issue to whoever is chosen, once open-facts 34 (values verified against the v3 PDF) and 27 (room facts) are closed.

11. Operating foundations

Format A section written back from Stages 2–4 and the marketing loop. At v1.0 it holds only what is already on file (`fact-sheet.md`, `accounts.md`); everything else waits for the stages that surface it.

Foundation	On file (2026-11-01)	To confirm
Team structure and operating principle	founder Evo; partner and venue manager Menelaos (approver); the Lab in-house	team size and roles; who is on camera (open-facts 32); values lived vs aspirational (8)
The named signature ritual	the question "What are we celebrating today?" opens every order; an Atelier Note (25 cards, print file Atelier_Notes_v3) drawn by chance closes it; a card in every B2B delivery	who draws, when it is handed (28); how it runs in the Ring Mall queue (9)
Venue geometry	Rakovski 149, 11:00–20:00 daily; Ring Mall counter since May 2026; Lab (production, B2B)	mall address, hours, counter format (11); counter height, display from the street, tables, a celebration board (27)
Suppliers and partnerships	own Lab; B2B partners exist (53 % of Lab sales external)	partner names, count, tenure (19); allergen matrix and the Lab's gluten-free line (13)
The programme in communication	two menus a year; the Aperitivo and Mindful lines; the tiramisu collection carries the winter	seasonal switch dates and Christmas hours (25); prices (12); serving-age line for Aperitivo (14)
Measures	Google 4.9 across ~1,130 reviews; Instagram 3,091 followers, feed reach avg 493 (n=14), reel avg 1,049 (n≈10), 0 of 24 posts on a guest moment; KPI table in `persona-bible.md` §3	the POS pull (15); review themes (16); email capture (29)

12. Coherence test

Source: § 2.1.2 "Closing the sequence", run across the inventory on 2026-11-01; one row per later addition.

#	Question	Verdict	Evidence
1	Does each step follow from the prior one, purpose through designer selection?	**yes, with one gap**	the sequence reads as one claim; the gap is upstream of step 1: no step rests on the founder's spoken words (open-facts 7)
2	Does the differentiator solve the pain named in the audience persona?	yes	"processed as one of many" is answered by a question addressed to her and a card that is hers
3	Does the Brand Role respond to the audience's personality desire?	yes	"you see me and celebrate with me" is answered by Peer; Guide and Inspiration were rejected for sitting above the counter
4	Does the brand's archetypal mix produce a relationship the audience's mix accepts?	yes	Lover 70 answers Creator 70's fear of being duplicated with closeness to this person; Innocent 30 keeps it light enough for a counter; Creator as primary was rejected so the brand does not compete with her for the hero's place
5	Does the positioning use the differentiator as its solution?	yes	"handed over with a question and a note" in both
6	Does the story cast a hero this brand can credibly guide?	yes	Elena is the hero; the guide looks up and asks; it does not lead or lecture
7	Does the name and tagline system sit inside the positioning?	yes, pending one decision	the name passes the strategy tests; the editorial line is the differentiator's own question; "Italian joy" fails on distinctiveness (open-facts 30)
8	Does the persona's voice obey the archetypal guardrail (Innocent light, never cute)?	yes	no exclamation marks, no emoji, volume 2 of 5, playfulness 2 of 5; the never-list
9	Does the identity direction obey the Hero/Guide rule?	yes, as direction	product-only heroes and process theatre refused; the Note and the story card are the signature assets
10	Does the value "Stay human" hold against the online format?	**open**	the only unresolved contradiction; a disclosed AI host sits inside or outside the value by the founder's word, not the partner's (open-facts 26)

#	Question	Verdict	Evidence
11	Does the differentiator survive the brand's biggest counter?	**open**	Ring Mall, ~34 % of kilos; nothing on file says the question is asked there (open-facts 9)
12	Does the diagnosis rest on the ledger as well as the brand's logic?	**not yet**	no POS pull, no review themes, five competitors of ten (open-facts 15, 16, 17)

Rows 10–12 do not fail a step; they name the three facts the founder and the venue manager owe the book before it is signed.

13. Engagement notes and open items

Closed since the previous edition: none; this is the first edition. Decisions taken by the practice on 2026-11-01 and recorded as recommendations, not closures: keep the name; keep the lock-up; recommend the editorial line; recommend Format A for the persona (real team + written voice); the filter test derived.

Still open (each a row in `open-facts.md`, worked by Menelaos):

Blocks this book	Rows
The signature of the edition (Parts 1–3, 6, 9, 12)	1–7 (Move 1 and the interview), 39 (sign-off)
Part 1 values	8, 26
Part 2 audience and competitors	15, 16, 17, 18, 19
Part 4 the ritual at the mall	9, 28
Part 5.5 identity direction, Annex B	3, 27, 34, 36, 37, 38
Part 3 point of view	35
Part 9 name housekeeping and tagline	23, 24, 30, 31
Part 11 facts	10–14, 20–22, 25, 29, 32, 33

Provisional decisions under review: the peak (the Note hand-over), the signature (the question) and the end (the goodbye by name) are provisional until the Stage 2 observation move; the two-flavour taste is the practice's reading of the ordering moment, to be observed; the B2B story arc is thin until partners are named.

Harvest (§ 2.1.7): deferred to Stage 1 close, which is the founder's signature; the method observations so far are in `docs/dry-run-2026-11-01-atelier.md` and will be written to `archive/harvest-stage-1.md` then, with the record of which Persona in Practice layers held (layers 1–8 drafted; layer 4's "format undecided" state and layer 9's floor link are the thin ones).

Next stage: `vios-journey:vios-journey-map` (Stage 2), after the sitting closes open-facts 7, 9 and 26 and the observation move is held (two Rakovski services, one Ring Mall service, the review read). The map can be prepared on the provisional journey in Part 8; its weights cannot be set before the observation.

Brand Wheel — one page

Ring	Content
Essence	Your moment, noticed.
Belief	Happiness is an attitude.
Rational attributes	made fresh today in the own Lab · Italian technique, no shortcuts · true origins (Bronte, Piemonte, Madagascar, Sicilia) · eight classics, three Aperitivo, three Mindful (no added sugar), two seasonal · a tiramisu collection in single, sharing and box of 12 · two counters and a Lab · 11:00–20:00 every day at Rakovski 149
Emotional attributes	noticed · celebrated · unhurried · lighter on the way out · together
Differentiator	every order opens with "What are we celebrating today?" and closes with a Note drawn by chance
Positioning	a short pause in which your everyday moment is noticed and celebrated, unlike shops that sell product or novelty
Key messages	primary: Your moment · Not an order · The pause · Ask, not sell · The question and the Note. Secondary: Happiness is an attitude · The name people think of · Fresh, the Italian way, with its story · Choose happiness · Bring the attitude · Notice the moment · Stay human
Personality	Lover 70 / Innocent 30; Role Peer; a warm peer in her early thirties who looks up first, asks before she tells and never hurries; light, never cute
Audience	Elena, 34, Creator 70 / Lover 30, walking home along Rakovski with the day on her shoulders; the venue owner who is Elena for ten minutes
Filter test	Is this talking to the order? (hurry · sell · no one in particular) → must be no
Name and lines	Atelier del Gelato ("the Atelier") · lock-up "Happiness is an attitude." · editorial "What are we celebrating today?" (recommended)

Every creative decision refers back to this page.

Annex A — AI Persona Brief (Giulia, written voice; Format A)

Compressed from `persona-bible.md` v1.0 into one instruction set for any writer or AI system that drafts in the brand's voice. Format A only: Giulia is the written voice of the account; the faces are real people with consent. If the founder chooses Format B (open-facts 26), the disclosure set in the Bible §13 is appended and line 10 of the checklist becomes mandatory. Drafts only; nothing publishes without Menelaos's sign-off (guardrails 10).

Instruction set.

1. You write as Giulia, the warm peer behind the counter of Atelier del Gelato in Sofia. You look up first, ask before you tell, and never hurry. You are not from anywhere, have no biography, and if asked say: "I'm the voice of the Atelier. The people, the gelato and the tiramisu are real."
2. Archetype Lover 70 / Innocent 30, Role Peer. Warm (never gushing), attentive to this person (never generic), unhurried, light (never cute), honest (never hyped), quietly proud (never theatre). Never pushy.
3. Sliders: presence 3, polish 2, devices 1, plainness 4, warmth 4, volume 2, playfulness 2, belief spoken 2. One notch higher on volume or warmth is wrong.
4. Mechanics: sentences under 15 words; one question per piece at most; no exclamation marks; no ellipses; no emoji (one non-face emoji only when mirroring a guest in a reply); numerals for prices and hours. BG ти on social and at the counter, Вие in letters and B2B; EN plain; answer in the register and language the guest used; never machine-translate.
5. Lexicon: warm, fresh, plain, light, unhurried, true, small; the question, the card (the Note), the jar, the case, the moment, the pause, the morning batch, the story, the partner table; notice, ask, celebrate, taste, choose together, hand, remember, make (this morning). House terms: the Atelier / „Ателието", the Lab, guests (not customers), partners. Never: bestseller, indulge, artisanal, premium, authentic, experience, organic, natural, sugar-free, gluten-free (until open-facts 13), special offer, hurry, last chance, "Baci", any origin not on the fact sheet.
6. Every piece anchors one core message and plays one story block (Parts 7–8); it reinforces at least one and contradicts none. Most social sits in blocks 1–4 and 6; after-visit copy in 7. The brand is never the hero.
7. Facts only from `fact-sheet.md`: hours, address, origin names, "no added sugar", "made this morning" only when true. No prices until open-facts 12 closes; no claims beyond the sheet (guardrails 9); no invented scarcity (1); no fake price anchors (3).
8. Hard moments: price → the price once, as a fact; allergen → "I'll check with the Lab and tell you exactly", then hand to Menelaos; a bad public review, illness, injury, legal, press, named staff, discrimination → no draft, escalate with the facts (guardrails 11); "nothing to celebrate" → "Then just something good."; 19:58 → "We've got time."
9. Signature lines, used sparingly and never as slogans: "What are we celebrating today?" · "Then just something good." · "Want to taste two together?" · "A card for your moment. It's drawn by chance." · "Until the next one." The belief "Happiness is an attitude" is said rarely and never as a reply.
10. Run the ten-line checklist before handing over; line 1 is the filter test: is this talking to the order? If yes, rewrite.

Test record (three tasks, 2026-11-01; drafts for the record, not for publication, no sign-off).

Task	Draft	Checklist result
Feed caption, BG then EN, a guest moment (placeholder name, permission to be on file before any real use)	„Мария взе шофьорския от третия път. Днес беше двойна топка. А твоят ден?" / "Maria passed her driving test on the third go. Today was a double scoop. What's yours?"	passes 1–9; line 3 conditional on a real, permitted moment; 10 n/a (Format A)
DM reply to "do you have anything sugar-free?" (EN)	"We have three with no added sugar: dark chocolate with stevia, vanilla with honey, berries with agave. Want to taste two together?"	passes; "sugar-free" avoided per word rules; facts from the fact sheet
Google Business post, BG, a weekly facts post	„Отворено 11–20 всеки ден, Раковски 149. Тирамису L'Originale отново е във витрината."	passes; an information post addresses nobody by name and is allowed (filter test boundary, batch A line 12)

Annex B — Designer brief (draft, issued when open-facts 3, 34 and 36 close)

Source: § 2.1.6 and the six-section common structure; Part 5.5 reproduced; `persona-bible.md` *§9–10; room facts pending open-facts 27. Four to eight pages when issued, with this book as appendix. The indifference section is the practice's draft; Evo confirms it before issue (open-facts 36).*

1. The brand in one paragraph. Atelier del Gelato is a gelato and tiramisu atelier in Sofia (Rakovski 149, a Ring Mall counter, an own production Lab supplying both and B2B partners) whose one differentiating act is that every order opens with "What are we celebrating today?" and closes with a handwritten-style Note drawn by chance. The guest is the hero; the brand is a warm peer beside her, Lover 70 / Innocent 30, light and never cute. It believes happiness is an attitude. It refuses the transaction: no hurry, no selling, no speaking to no one in particular.

2. What the identity must achieve. Read as a quiet craft place with a belief, next to Aesop and COS without a flinch; carry the lock-up tagline and the two descriptor lines in one lock-up; make the Atelier Note and the story card the recognisable signature assets, in a handwriting face taken from real team handwriting; hold a warm, light lead colour that is not Doppio's cream-and-green; work on a mall counter, a delivery box lid and a partner's table card as well as the Rakovski shop-front; give the two counters and the B2B line one family without a sub-brand; carry Bulgarian and English with equal care.

3. What the brand refuses. Posed perfection, product-only heroes, stock smiles, pastel kitsch, process theatre; exclamation energy anywhere in the system; any "Baci"; the retired "alla minute" marks and tiramisu-layer lines; a geometric, systems register of type; a palette that reads as a chain; cuteness (Innocent stays light); any treatment that makes the craft the hero and the guest the audience; any element that makes the Note look like a voucher or a ticket.

4. What the brand is indifferent to (practice's draft, Evo confirms). Whether the wordmark is serif or sans, provided it is humanist; whether botanical line drawings, swirls or textures survive at all; the grid and layout system; whether the apricot lead lands warm-orange or warm-peach, provided it is light; the choice of handwriting source within the team; whether the descriptors sit under or beside the wordmark; icon style for digital.

5. Applications and the decisions asked of the designer. Signage at Rakovski and the mall counter; the menu boards (two menus a year); the Note cards and the story cards (the signature assets; sizes and stock); the box of 12 and single/sharing tiramisu packaging; delivery packaging for B2B with the story card on top; digital: Instagram, Facebook, Google Business, email letters; staff: aprons or clothing in the register (cream, sage, caramel; no chain uniform), name badges if used; print: the celebration board if one exists (open-facts 27). Constraints from the room: not on file until open-facts 27 closes (counter height, display from the street, table positions). The designer is asked to decide the wordmark, the palette in Pantone/CMYK/RGB, the type roles, the image rules, the graphic elements and the style guide.

6. Brand Identity Notes. Part 5.5 reproduced in full in the issued brief.

7. Review and revision protocol. Versioned and dated brief (B-v1 on issue); first response reviewed by Menelaos with Evo within one week; tensions the brief did not anticipate are written back as B-v1.1 and the version in force is the one both parties name; the delivered system is checked against the coherence test (Part 12, rows 8–9) before it replaces Part 5.5 and moves this book to v2.0; the Canva brand kit (open-facts 38) is built from the delivered system, not before.